

FATHER SOLANUS, NOTEBOOK No. 2

- Pg. 44 object of my existence, Hell is the only alternative.
(cont'd.) In other words, man was made to fill up the places of glory left vacant by the perfidy of angels that fell from Heaven; created and bound in conscience under pain of eternal damnation to co-
- Pg. 45 operate with God's grace in attaining this object. Not only therefore does the future of human society depend on the children, but Heaven itself will not be complete without them. "For such is the kingdom of Heaven." Hence the momentuous importance of caring for the children. Hence the momentuous importance of cooperating with Almighty God in His work of bring them into existence, of keeping them safe in child-hood - guarding them physically and morally from evil influences, training their minds, their hearts, their little consciences to adhere to the good to avoid evil - in short, to perfect the image of God in their souls - to know and to love God and thus be happy in time and for all eternity. O, brethren, what privileges are the duties of Christian parents and teachers! The more we think of it the more sublime appears their vocation. But what obligations too dear Br. and what responsibilities! - to bring the little children to Jesus; to suffer them to come to Him - which means in a few years to sanctify youth and in a generation to fill the world with virtuous men and women and the Church of God with saints. "For better is one that feareth the Lord than a thousand ungodly children. But how shall we do all this? Jesus answers this question Himself. "Suffer the little children to come to me -- if you would have grateful children - sons and daughters that fear the Lord and love His laws and His representatives bring them to me when they are little. For without me you can do nothing." These last words can never be emphasised enough." If Jesus assures his apostles that without Him they can do nothing - even as the branch without the vine - if the Apostles or we can do nothing without Jesus toward saving our own souls, then I ask you what can we expect to do for others without Jesus? The answer is evident, "without me you can do nothing." But the Apostle St. Paul assures us that with Jesus everything is possible. "I can do all things in Him that strengtheneth me." For 4000 years men waited for the Messiah and wept, as deeper and deeper they sank into sin and despair. Jesus alone brought